- If the state does not license Ambulatory Surgical Centers and the facility is not Medicare certified as an ambulatory surgical center, then they must be accredited with AAAHC (Accreditation Association for Ambulatory Health Care), AAAASF (American Association for Accreditation for Ambulatory Surgery Facilities), IMQ (Institute for Medical Quality) or TJC (The Joint Commission).
- Ambulatory Surgical Facilities in the state of California do not require a license if they are physician owned. To be covered, these facilities must be accredited by one of the following: AAAHC (Accreditation Association for Ambulatory Health Care), AAAASF (American Association for Accreditation for Ambulatory Surgery Facilities), IMQ (Institute for Medical Quality) or TJC (The Joint Commission).

• Hospital
  - An institution or distinct portion of an institution that is primarily engaged in providing: (1) general inpatient acute care and treatment of sick and injured persons through medical, diagnostic, and major surgical facilities; or (2) specialized inpatient acute medical care and treatment of sick or injured persons through medical and diagnostic facilities (including x-ray and laboratory); or (3) comprehensive specialized services relating to the individual's specific medical, physical, mental health, and/or substance use disorder therapy needs, and has, for each patient, an individualized written treatment plan, which includes diagnostic assessment of the patient and a description of the treatment to be rendered, and provides for follow-up assessments by, or under, the direction of the supervising doctor.
  - All services must be provided on its premises, under its control, or through a written agreement with a hospital or with a specialized provider of those facilities.
  - A hospital must be operated pursuant to law, accredited as a hospital under the Hospital Accreditation Program of The Joint Commission (TJC) or meet the states' applicable licensing or certification requirements for a hospital, and is operating under the supervision of a staff of physicians with 24-hour-a-day registered nursing services.
  - The term hospital does not include a convalescent home, extended care facility, skilled nursing facility, or any institution or part thereof which: (1) is used principally as a convalescent facility, nursing facility, or long-term care facility; (2) furnishes primarily domiciliary or custodial care, including training in the routines of daily living; or (3) is operating as or is licensed as a school or residential treatment facility (except as listed in Section 5(e)).

• Hospice - A facility which meets all of the following:
  - Primarily provides inpatient hospice care to terminally ill persons;
  - Is certified by Medicare as such, or is licensed or accredited as such, by the jurisdiction it is in;
  - Is supervised by a staff of M.D.'s or D.O.'s, at least one of whom must be on call at all times;
  - Provides 24-hour-a-day nursing services under the direction of an R.N. and has a full-time administrator; and
  - Provides an ongoing quality assurance program.

• Skilled Nursing Facility licensed by the state or certified by Medicare if the state does not license these facilities. See limitations in Section 5(c), *Services Provided by a Hospital or Other Facility, and Ambulance Services*.

• Birth Center
  - A birth center is a health facility that is not a hospital or physician’s office, where childbirth is planned to occur away from the pregnant woman’s residence, that is licensed or otherwise approved by the state to provide prenatal, labor and delivery, or postpartum care that is covered by the plan.